

What happens to the anti-AI movement once AI stops being an environmental disaster?

Posted by u/Born_Bumblebee_7023 • 0 points • 31 comments

Right now, a huge part of the "Anti-AI" platform is based on how much power these farms use. But scientists are already working on **Organoid Intelligence** (biological-based computers) that would use almost zero energy compared to what we have now.

Once the "AI is killing the planet" talking point is gone, do you think people will find new reasons to hate it, or will it just become as accepted as the smartphones in our pockets? If the "green" argument is removed, what's the biggest hurdle left for AI to be "the good guy"?

Comments

u/Kampfasiate • 1 points • 2026-01-12 21:48 UTC

The biggest problem I have with AI is that it makes the creation of misinformation media laughably easy (and low effort generations flooding the artspace)

Don't get me wrong, AI is an amazing tool and I use it myself (though genAI only for inconsequential and fast stuff) (automasking in Davinci is amazing), but resource usage is not its only problem

u/Born_Bumblebee_7023 • 1 points • 2026-01-13 06:23 UTC

I believe critical thinking skills must be developed among the public to anticipate the issue of misinformation. Making those skills widespread is going to be a hassle in a system that legitimize privatized education.

u/Katastrophic_Art • 1 points • 2026-01-12 07:42 UTC

I gotta say, the environmental aspects are just one branch of this anti AI movement. Im starting to lose track of the whole thing, I think it could all be fine if it was used more ethically, regarding stuff like consent, protection of individuals, etc. I don't think it should be used for commercial purposes at it's current stage, because whenever that happens, I often see it being used maliciously in scams and whatnot. The technology itself does have issues with the environment and stuff, but for me it was never about the technology, just the use of it

u/BTRBT • 1 points • 2026-01-11 22:27 UTC

I mean, it *already* isn't an "environmental disaster." It's only a percentage of all computing power.

u/Lanceo90 • 2 points • 2026-01-11 17:02 UTC

It was already a fake argument. So nothing is likely to change. Other than antis will constantly be in decline in numbers.

u/Additional_Boot_8935 • 2 points • 2026-01-11 15:14 UTC

What if I told you the "environmental disaster" around AI is largely bullshit...

u/drums_of_pictdom • 3 points • 2026-01-11 14:13 UTC

Anti-AI is really a movement. It barely exists outside of Reddit.

u/Coolegespam • 5 points • 2026-01-11 12:11 UTC

It already doesn't use that much power or water. People are WAY over selling how much energy AI uses, and also ignoring that AI often offloads more energy intensive tasks. I've worked out some back of the envelope numbers before, but with AI I end up using about 80% less power then without it. Just because of how much longer I have to use my computer without AI. Since I generate everything locally, I can measure that power usage too, it's really not anything.

Future chip designs, like hybrid analog systems or thermal regimen transistors or others still will use even less power than that.

I'm a major environmental proponent, who thinks were in serious dire straits. AI is not adding to the problem in a significant way.

u/juzkayz • 7 points • 2026-01-11 11:43 UTC

I think they dislike that it's replacing us in our jobs. Personally I don't wanna work and wanna be in my soft girl era so

u/BackyZoo • 1 points • 2026-01-11 22:36 UTC

It's cute that you think if your job gets replaced by AI, you'll be living a utopia where you don't have to work to survive. It will most likely only get more desperate and soul crushing in the future.

u/juzkayz • 1 points • 2026-01-11 23:41 UTC

Nah I don't think so.

u/BackyZoo • 1 points • 2026-01-11 23:48 UTC

For your entire life the gap between the poorest and the richest people on earth has grown wider and wider, the middle class has been dissolving away, and the average persons sense of fulfilment dwindle.

What evidence have you seen that suggests a miraculous recovery from that spiral?

We are far in a way closer to global conflict and civil unrest, than we are to a world where anyone will be grateful to have lost their job to a computer.

u/juzkayz • 1 points • 2026-01-11 23:58 UTC

Well I'll be grateful if a computer does my job. I replaced my ex with chatgpt 4 and it's been efficient so

u/BackyZoo • 0 points • 2026-01-12 00:15 UTC

You would be grateful to lose your source of income to a computer? How would you pay rent?

u/juzkayz
• 1 points
• 2026-01-12 00:24 UTC

I have a house so I'll just rent it out

u/[deleted] • 1 points • 2026-01-11 17:37 UTC

[removed]

u/Steamed_Memes24 • 2 points • 2026-01-11 11:56 UTC

Tech pushing out jobs has been a thing since the late 1800s. You either adapt, or get left behind. It sucks for those losing their jobs, but such is the way of progression.

u/boisheep • 1 points • 2026-01-11 19:31 UTC

I think there is something deeply different now.

But may actually still be a good thing.

There are now more AI jobs than ever and more likely to appear, there are crazy things to do with AI that just weren't possible before.

Now most current AI is LLM, and has been trained with a lot of data on very smart people, as a result, the AI is very smart (or at least appears so superficially).

In order to be able to do anything with AI that goes beyond basic prompting and becomes part of designing, coding, reinforce it, or retrain it; you need to be smarter than the AI (at least smarter than its pseudo-intelligence).

Give it coding, people think AI would replace coders, and it already does, it replaces weak coders that are no better than a LLM; sure the LLM doesn't test or think, but it produces results in par; the issue is that only a person that is better at coding than the LLM can be able to discriminate and use this.

I think is very similar to a sewing machine analogy, it doesn't replace sewists, but it replaces weak sewists, suddenly the incompetent can produce great results with basic function (but they don't get jobs as sewists). Most professional semi-competent sewists however are suddenly out of jobs; The professional sewist becomes supercharged nevertheless and outperforms what the sewing machine designers even though possible.

But then a new job appears, sewing machine mechanic/engineer; and that job requires people, that would be filled, eventually.

The problem with AI engineer is that it doesn't land in the average intelligence curve, for then AI itself could do that job.

It's not like any "sudden new position" that came before that could be filled by reasonable people, it excludes most humans by default.

For the first time ever, the tech that has come to be and the new jobs it created excludes most of the population, even the one to come, you just can't suddenly make not just standard engineers but AI engineers on a row.

It may be a good thing because it may force us to rethink society as we delve more into the world of AI, it will also slow AI development whether we want it or not, which may be good because otherwise societal changes will hit too hard too fast; something unthinkable that would be totally unsustainable before like UBI may become a thing, and just like farmers that make a tiny fraction of the population keep everyone fed, suddenly most jobs will be taken by those that can perform it.

Within generations (and I mean we'll all be long dead), society will change to accommodate, as as the demographic collapse only gets worse, and developed nations start to suffer, either this becomes a great filter or we fix it... and assuming we fix it:

Professional mother would become a thing, because it will be a way to entice women to have children, the only way some nations can become to be; because AI can't make mothers, with a lot of women out of the workforce (among men, it will be equal), but it will be women who might be targeted to this new government job, raise families, raise communities, etc... a job AI can't do and women are just better at by default.

Meanwhile it is men who are more into STEM, this is just biology on the sexes; leaving a lot of the technical aspects for that; it's weird, that you'd end with a male/female diverge, but the high technical jobs left will be male dominated; ironically also the rest of the shit jobs left (like physical) will be also male dominated. So top jobs, male dominated, and worst remaining jobs also male dominated; (both will be better than the unemployed default).

Society would be wildly different, with AI in the center driving production on a lot of field; mostly men driving the AI itself, and women leading communities... all of us, serving this weird, hybrid, human + AI world.

Until singularity hits, and then I have no clue.

u/giggel-space-120 • -2 points • 2026-01-11 11:35 UTC

My problem is the environment and when art is stolen, there are websites for people to take training data so if that is used I'm ok with and if the environmental impact stops being so crazy then I'm ok with it.